

OUTLINE OF EVIDENCE – MS PATRICIA CONAGHAN

Served pursuant to direction 2 of the Further Directions Order (3) dated 19 August 2026. Not filed in the Industrial Registry.

Ms Conaghan is an Administration Officer in Switchboard Services at Logan Hospital and has worked in that department alongside the Appellant. She is expected to give evidence of the following.

1. That she and the Appellant each sought an additional two shifts per fortnight, as recorded in his email of 7 August 2023 to Ms Taylor, Ms Reese, Ms Conaghan and Ms Smith.
2. The calls the Switchboard receives and what they are: that a substantial proportion come from people who are distressed, frightened, angry or abusive; that some callers make threats, including threats of harm to the operator, and demand the name of the operator they are speaking to; that calls of that kind are a regular and continuing feature of the work at the console and not occasional events; that the operator on duty is the first person they reach; and that she observed the Appellant receiving such calls.
3. What she observed of clinicians and departments remaining on the line to express their frustration to the operator on duty, and treating the operator as accountable for matters that were the responsibility of others.
4. Occasions she observed of complaints being directed at the Appellant at the console, including an orthopaedic doctor who complained about the Appellant following a change in the way that doctor was to be contacted, and a clinician who made repeated complaints through the Switchboard.
5. The process for relaying urgent pathology results before and after the changes made to the Switchboard process: what the process was, what it became, and what she was told at the console by those calling back about results that had not reached the treating team.
6. What she observed of the Appellant updating pager and contact numbers at the console, and of pager and number updates left unactioned over extended periods.
7. What she was told at the console between 2 and 8 May 2024 by callers reporting that calls had reached the wrong medical team, including calls concerning emergency responses.
8. That during that period operators had no means of correcting an incorrect entry in the directory themselves.
9. That the Communication Book was used by the Switchboard team to communicate and for matters of handover; that she has read it in the course of handover throughout the period she has worked with the Appellant; and that she has not seen in it any entry made by the Appellant that criticised any person, directly or indirectly.
10. That she was not consulted about the change to after-hours on-call arrangements notified by Ms Taylor to the Switchboard on 15 April 2024, and was not asked to vote on that change.
11. That she was not consulted about, and was not balloted in relation to, changes to the Switchboard roster at any time before 30 June 2024.
12. Any change she observed in the Appellant at work over the period, from her own observation. She offers no opinion as to diagnosis or cause.
13. That in the time they have worked together she has not heard the Appellant speak of Ms Taylor, or of any other member of staff, in hostile terms.

This outline is a summary of the evidence the witness is expected to give. It is not a statement of the witness and is not signed by the witness.